

Carba Mix



What is it?

Carba mix is a blend of 3 chemicals used in curing rubber. A positive patch test to carba mix can be from any one of these.

These are rubber accelerators. A rubber accelerator is a chemical used when making rubber. It speeds up the liquid to solid rubber transformation. It can become a part of the final product in this process. This may cause allergic contact dermatitis. Note that this is different from a latex allergy.

Carba mix is a blend of two dithiocarbamates and a non-carbamate. This includes:

- 1,3-Diphenylguanidine (DPG)
- Zinc diethyldithiocarbamate (ZDC)
- Zinc dibutyldithiocarbamate (ZBC)

These are all rubber accelerators.

CARBA MIX can also be known as:

- 1,3-Diphenylguanidine - DPG, Sanceler D, Nocceler D, Soxinol D
- Zinc diethyldithiocarbamate - Etazin, Ethasan, Ethazate, Ethyl Zimate, Nocceler EZ, Soxinol EZ, ZDC, ZDEC
- Zinc dibutyldithiocarbamate - ZBC, BUTYL Zimate, Soxinol BZ, Butasan, Butazin, Nocceler BZ, Butazate

Some Possible Uses of CARBA MIX / Where it might be found:

- Rubber and nitrile gloves
- Rubber shoes, insoles, soles
- Rubber hip waders, gators
- Elastic in clothing, socks, and girdle
- Support stockings

- Non-slip waist bands, elastics
- Brassiere cups, underwear, or panties
- Feminine hygiene products
- Swimwear, swim cap, goggles, sauna suits
- Wet suit, diving gear
- Rubber pillow, mattress, or sheet
- Makeup applicator, lash curler
- Ear plugs, headphones
- Hairbrush handle, hairnet
- Toothbrush handle, dentures, dental dams
- Baby bottle nipples, pacifiers
- Balloons, balls, toys
- Medical devices (stethoscope, IV port, tourniquet, BP cuff, CPAP strap, tubing)
- Dialysis equipment
- Braces and supports
- Safety aprons, goggles
- Respirators, masks
- Microscope eyepiece
- Rubber prosthesis and splint
- Rubber dropper
- Bunion pad
- Condom or diaphragm
- Rubber vibrator
- Phone armband
- Pen handle, pencil grip, eraser
- Mouse pad, wrist support
- Glue, envelopes, stamps
- Rubber cement, Rubber bands
- Kitchen utensil rubber handle
- Rubber mats, carpet backing, underlay pad
- Racquet and club handles
- Hockey pads, soccer shin pad
- Foam shoulder pad
- Rubber hose, tubing, seals, cables
- Steering wheel, bike handle
- Auto hoses, gaskets, fan belts

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- Shock absorbers, springs, tires, inner tubes, Fuel tank lining
- Duct tape, Electrical cords, tool handles
- Weather stripping
- Conveyor belt
- Synthetic resins in textile/dye industry
- Some, but not all, Neoprene (polychloroprene)

Other products that might react like CARBA MIX:

- Thiurams
- Tetramethylthiuram monosulfide
- Tetramethylthiuram disulfide
- Dipentamethylenethiuram disulfide
- Disulfiram
- Manganese salts of diethyl- or dibutyl-dithiocarbamates

What should I do to avoid CARBA MIX?

Avoid items that have carbamates.

Use VINYL, non-latex gloves when you clean the house or wash dishes.

Wear heavy duty vinyl gloves to protect against workplace contact. Use fabric, leather, or plastic gloves if you need to touch dry rubber. If you think that you have workplace exposure, consult the Material Safety Data Sheet (MSDS), or contact the manufacturer.

Elastic waistbands and underwear with elastic may contain rubber. Choose underwear that does not have an elastic waistband, or buy all-cotton clothing (cottonique.com, rawganique.com, decentexposures.com; make sure rubber-free).

Rubber may be in some forms of contraception. This includes condoms or diaphragms. There are condoms made of materials safe for those allergic to rubber or latex. The options for male condoms are: polyurethane (Trojan Supra) or lambskin (Trojan Naturalamb).

If you are carba sensitive and have foot dermatitis, it may be due to shoes containing rubber. Wear all leather shoes with no inner or outer sole, like moccasins. Molded plastic shoes or wooden clogs are an option. Contact a local shoe store and ask for a rubber-free shoe or contact an orthotic shop to have a custom made shoe. If this is not possible, remove the insoles. Insert insoles cut from piano felt, cork, or plastic. Limit sweating. Throw away socks that may have absorbed allergen.

Ask your provider for other options if your products or items may contain rubber.

What gloves may NOT have Carba Mix?

- Household use:
 - Vinyl, non-latex gloves
- Medical Examination (non-sterile) gloves:
 - Ansell Micro-Touch NitraFree
 - Cardinal Health Low Dermatitis Potential Nitrile
 - Medline SensiCare Powder-Free
 - Sempermed SemperSure Nitrile
 - Showa N-Dex Accelerator-free Nitrile
 - SmartPractice Reflection Sky Sensitive Nitrile
- Surgical (sterile) gloves:
 - Ansell GAMMEX Non-Latex Neoprene Surgical

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- Cardinal Health Protexis Neoprene Essential Surgical
- Medline DermAssure Green Powder-Free Neoprene Surgical
- Mölnlycke Health Biogel NeoDerm Surgical
- Chemical resistant gloves:
 - Honeywell Safety Silvershield/4H chemically resistant

For more rubber-accelerator free glove options: *Dermatitis* 2018;29:66; *Dermatitis* 2018;29:13.

For more rubber-free options: *Dermatitis* 2019;30:87.

In addition, the ACDS Contact Allergen Management Program® (CAMP®) can help manage contact dermatitis. It helps to find products that are safe to use by creating a list of products that do not contain one's allergens. For more information about CAMP®, please ask your doctor or visit www.contactderm.org.

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